

Individual Reflection – Group Member 4 (Raheem Kisting ITCLIT240956)

Reflection on My Contribution to the Kalahari Logistics Project

As Group Member 4, my main responsibility in this project was to assist with the practical implementation of the Kalahari Logistics network using Cisco Packet Tracer, as well as managing the GitHub and documentation aspects of the project. I was responsible for working with the network topology and helping configure the routers, switches, WAN connections, end devices and the Windhoek wireless access point. I also helped organise the project files and screenshots for the GitHub repository.

One of the biggest learning experiences for me was configuring the four-site network and understanding how the different networks communicate with one another. I worked with IPv4 addressing and configured separate LAN networks for Windhoek, Walvis Bay, Johannesburg and London. I also worked with serial WAN connections between the sites. During the configuration process, I encountered situations where interfaces appeared to be down, which required me to investigate the configuration and understand the difference between physical/interface status and protocol status. This improved my troubleshooting skills and taught me the importance of checking configurations carefully rather than assuming that a connected cable means the interface is operational.

I was also involved in configuring the Windhoek switches and access point. Configuring the wireless network helped me understand how wireless devices can be integrated into an existing LAN. I configured the access point and worked on connecting wireless laptops so that they could communicate with the network. This was particularly useful because it allowed me to apply concepts from the theoretical part of the assignment to an actual simulated network.

Another important part of my contribution was the **GitHub repository**. I helped organise the repository structure so that the Packet Tracer file, report, screenshots and reflections could be stored in appropriate folders. This gave me practical experience with version control and showed me how GitHub can be used to manage a group project and keep evidence of progress. I also learned that meaningful commits and proper organisation are important when several members are contributing to the same project.

The project was not without challenges. At times, configuration issues made it difficult to determine why a connection was not working as expected. However, working through these problems helped me become more comfortable with commands such as show ip interface brief and using ping to test connectivity. I learned that systematic troubleshooting is much more effective than changing multiple settings without understanding the cause of the problem.

Overall, my contribution to the project improved both my **technical networking skills and my ability to work collaboratively on a larger project**. I gained practical experience with Cisco Packet Tracer, routers, switches, wireless networking, IP addressing, WAN connectivity, troubleshooting and GitHub. Most importantly, I learned that successful network design requires planning, accurate configuration, testing and documentation. This project has given me greater confidence in working with network infrastructure and has helped me understand how the concepts studied in class can be applied to a realistic business environment.

